Figure Out What Changed, What Needs a Professional, and Who Needs to Know

Four prompts to list what's different since your father's plan was written, trace each change to the part of the plan it touches, separate questions for professionals from things the family can handle, and assign who tells whom.

Where you are

Your father's care plan was written in the spring. Since then his walking has gotten worse, his morning aide gave notice, and he's started refusing the day program. Everyone agrees things have changed. Nobody has written down what, and your brother is still working from the old plan.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can hand the care team a dated list of what's changed, know which items need their review before anything is altered, and know who in the family tells whom once decisions are made.

A one-page change list: What's changed (with dates), What part of the plan it touches, What needs professional review, and Who needs to know.

Before you start

- The current written care plan, or the closest thing to it, with the date it was made.
- Your notes, texts, or memories of what's different, however scattered.
- A list of everyone who works from the plan: family, aides, the agency, the doctor's office. Partial is fine; the prompts will show you what's missing.

PROMPT 1

List what's actually different since the plan was written

WHY THIS MATTERS

Everyone in the family knows something has changed, and everyone means something slightly different. Writing the changes down with dates turns 'he's declining' into a list the care team can respond to.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The date the plan was written and your notes on what's different, worries and all.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My father's care plan was written on [DATE OF PLAN]. Here is what I've noticed is different since then, in my own words, mixed up with my worries:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort it into three lists: CHANGES IN MY FATHER (what he can do, what he wants, how he's been), CHANGES IN WHO HELPS (availability, schedules, people leaving or joining), and CHANGES WE'RE NOT SURE ABOUT. For each item, note when I first noticed it and who told me or saw it. Put anything that is a worry rather than an observed change into a fourth list called WORRIES. Do not tell me what any change means medically or whether he needs a different level of care.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Changes you can date against changes you've assumed. The dated ones are what the care team can work with.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the other relatives and the aide whether they've noticed changes you haven't listed.

PROMPT 2

Trace each change to the part of the plan it touches

WHY THIS MATTERS

A plan goes out of date one line at a time. Finding the exact lines that no longer describe your father, and the changes the plan never anticipated, tells you what the review actually has to cover.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The plan and your dated list of changes from Prompt 1.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my father's current care plan:
>
> [PASTE THE PLAN]
>
> And here is my dated list of changes:
>
> [PASTE PROMPT 1]
>
> For each change, name the section or item of the plan it affects, quoting the plan's words, and say whether the plan now describes something that is no longer true, something that is still true,

> or something it never covered. Put the changes that touch nothing in the plan under NOT IN THE PLAN. Don't rewrite the plan or suggest new instructions; just show me where the old document and the new reality have come apart.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Sections of the plan that quietly stopped being true, and changes the plan never saw coming.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Mark those sections on a printed copy so you can point to them in a meeting.

PROMPT 3

Separate what needs a professional from what the family can handle

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some changes are logistics: who drives on Thursdays now that the aide is leaving. Others touch his health or the instructions in his plan, and those need the people responsible for them to look first. Mixing the two leads families to change things they shouldn't, or wait on things they needn't.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The matched list from Prompt 2.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the changes in my father's situation matched to his care plan:
>
> [PASTE PROMPT 2]
>
> Sort each change into three columns: NEEDS PROFESSIONAL REVIEW (anything touching his health, medication, safety, mobility, or the plan's care instructions), FAMILY LOGISTICS (schedules, who drives, who visits), and NOT SURE. For the first column, write the question we'd ask and the kind of professional who would normally answer it: his doctor or nurse, the agency or residence, a therapist, or our care consultant. When in doubt, put it in NEEDS PROFESSIONAL REVIEW. Do not answer the questions, and do not suggest changing any instruction or medication yourself.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A question list you can take to the next appointment, and a smaller pile of things the family can just sort out.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Call the agency or residence and ask how a family requests a care-plan review, and when the next one is scheduled.

PROMPT 4

Put the changes and the messengers on one page

WHY THIS MATTERS

The most common failure here is quiet: one relative updates a document, the aide keeps following the old one, and nobody notices for weeks. Naming who tells whom is how the whole team ends up on the same page.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts and a list of everyone who works from the plan.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've organized about the changes in my father's care:
>
> [PASTE PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> These are the people who work from his plan: [LIST FAMILY, AIDES, AGENCY, DOCTOR'S OFFICE, OTHERS].
>
> Write one page with four headings: WHAT'S CHANGED (with dates), WHAT PART OF THE PLAN IT TOUCHES, WHAT NEEDS PROFESSIONAL REVIEW, and WHO NEEDS TO KNOW. Under the last heading, for each change list who should be told and who in the family will tell them, and add a line reading 'Plan version in use: [DATE]. Nothing on this page is a decision until the care team reviews it.' Do not fill in any decision or recommend any change.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page that makes it obvious the plan is out of date without claiming to be the new one.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send it to everyone under WHO NEEDS TO KNOW and bring it to the review.

Give the changes a baseline

A change is only visible against a clear starting picture. The care interview organizes your father's current situation into a Family Care Profile, so the next time something shifts, you and the care team are comparing against the same file.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›